

Agustín Issidoro

Object or Cake?

*for one singer, violin, viola, cello, double-bass,
electronics and video.*

Techniques and Symbols

General

Performance actions are always indicated in boxed text like this.



Click on / Instruction. Performers can expect either a simple click track or a verbal instruction and a count-in for it.



Click track off.

Strings

Right hand technique:

n.p. *normal pressure*

x.p. *extremo ponticello*

x.t. *extremo tast*

flautando *fast bow with very soft pressure*

scratch noise *with no pitch content*

semi-scratch *pitch with noise content*

pizzicato Bartok

mute / damp string

col legno jeté

Left hand technique:

vib. *vibrando (always progressive unless explicitly stated)*

Red box is for going out from the front of the screen and hiding

Green box is for coming out from behind a screen and posing in front.

Playing Notes

Strings

From the beginning until letter O included the piece must be played by heart together with audio cues. It is not absolutely necessary that the performers know the music exactly to the core, but that they are able to recall the actions from the audio cues. The audio cues will quickly describe the action, count in and count out for each action. There's no possibility of playing the piece sight-reading a score until this point. After this, a score can be provided to read.

Click Track Notes

Each performer has an individual in-ear monitoring track with an individual click track and individual audio cues. For this purpose, the string should wear **ONLY** the indicated head-phone, as follows:

Violin = Left Earpod

Viola = Right Earpod

Celli = Left Earpod

Double-bass = Right Earpod

Object or Cake?

Agustín Issidoro
2025

♩ = 60

behind curtains, in front of screen 0

Julia

behind screen 3

Wakako

behind screen 2

Zeynep

behind screen 4

Antonio

behind screen 1

Ricardo

00:00

Electronics

Slowly begin to open the curtains. The curtains open as the chord in electronics builds, aprox. 50 sec. Hold a fashion model pose.

12

Jul.

Wak.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elect.

Curtains should be completely open now. You stay posing, staring at a fix point in the public. Confident. Even when you listen the video kicking in, you hold position.

01:28



Conclusive emphasis.

36  Relax. Stay still.

Jul.    Keep last intonations and increase in expressivity and articulations. Longer, more emphasized/stylized. And pose!

Wak.  Enter left screen 3. No inst. Costume 1. Relaxed pose, neutral.  Pose like a model.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elect. 02:20

when we walk the streets when the night has fallen

=

44

Jul.  when we take a long shit  after a heart operation  during our kids graduation  when we don't want it 

Wak.  Exit right behind screen 2  Costume 2 and connect microphone!

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.  Enter right screen 1. No inst. Costume 1. Pose like a model.

Elect.

51

Jul. *we watch* Relax. Stay still. *when we drive a car*

Wak. Relax. Stay still. Pose!

Ric. Relax. Stay still. Pose!

Elect. 03:07

75 116

75 116

9 3 5

8 4 4

8 4 4

12 13

Ant.



59

Jul. *at night* *when we are at work* *ten minutes before is too late* *after getting very drunk* *when we're in the bus*

Wak. Enter left screen 2. No inst. Costume 1. Pose like a model.

Ric. Exit left behind screen 4

Elect.

4 6 11 4 7 4 5 9

4 4 8 8 4 8 4 4 9

12 13

Ant.

68

Jul. *when we're not in love* *no!* *we scroll* *in our dreams* *and in our fantasies* *we scroll*

Wak.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric. Costume 2 and connect microphone!

Elect.

77

Jul. 70 Relax. Stay still. 116 Almost singing! Very nostalgic (not sad) pose tenderly, like hugging someone. *when we are sad* *when out of hope* *when tomorrow makes no difference*

Wak. 70 116 With your left hand, turn off the light over your right shoulder, then exit left to screen 3 Costume 2 and connect microphone!

Zey.

Ant. Enter left screen 4. No inst. Costume 1. Relaxed pose, neutral. Pose like a model!

Ric.

Elect. 04:02

87

Copy last phrases, should be the same.

Jul. *we count* *when we're feeling lonely* *when we're wasted* *when we're logged in our profiles*

Wak. *behind the bridge*

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elect.

With violin. Enter left screen 3. Costume 2.

Prepare to play

f

Exit screen right. Pick up broom, clean in front of screen 2 and hide behind screen 2.

96

Jul. *we count*

Wak. *col legno jeté* *Be very expressive! arco* *p*

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elect.

110 Relax. Stay still.

110 Be very expressive! arco

119 A bit more anger and grain in the voice, a bit louder. Pose is more angry and defying.

119 Exit right to screen 1

the first we think of when we're back to our bodies

Costume 2 and connect microphone!

05:00

106

Jul. *the last thing we also think of* $\frac{5}{4}$ *when we're about to disappear* $\frac{6}{8}$ $\frac{7}{8}$ *the very moment of becoming* $\frac{4}{4}$ $\frac{5}{8}$ $\frac{7}{8}$ *again and again*

Wak.

Zey. *With viola. Enter right screen 2. Costume 2.* *Prepare to play.* *sea-gull effect, alla punta* *Repeat exactly the body gesture!* *mf* *f* *mf* *f* *mf* *f*

Ant.

Ric. *With bass. Enter left screen 4. Costume 2.* *Prepare to play.* *Be exaggerated with the hand movement* *Repeat exactly the body gesture!* *ff*

Elect.

F The rest of 7/8 measures are repetitions. Repeat your pose each measure, like a loop!



115

Jul. $\frac{4}{4}$ *we like* $\frac{7}{8}$

Wak. $\frac{7}{8}$ *With violin. Enter left screen 1. Costume 3.* *Prepare to play.*

Zey. *Reposition to as if you were about to play one more, but hold!* *Change screen: exit left and go to screen 2* *Prepare to play.* *mf* *f* *mf* *f* *mf* *f* *mf* *f* *mf* *f*

Ant. *With cello. Enter right screen 2. Costume 2.* *Prepare to play.*

Ric. *Reposition to as if you were about to play one more, but hold!* *Rest and then slowly take and prepare the bow.* *Prepare to play.*

Elect.

G Again singing, like in D, nostalgic AND sad AND intimate. More lyrical.

126 ♩ = 58

Jul. when our face is caught by that sunless light so bright in the stream of pixels when we imagine how our lives would be

Wak. **G** ♩ = 58 ord. → xp. n.p. → semi-scr. n.p. mute string and scratch

Zey. vib. n.p. → semi-scr. n.p. mute string and scratch

Ant. ord. → xp. vib. mute string and scratch

Ric. ord. → xp. vib. mute string and scratch

Elect. 05:52



133

H

Jul. so perfect we smile

Wak. silencio súbito n.p. → scratch flautando x.p. slowly prepare a neutral standing position

Zey. silencio súbito n.p. → scratch flautando x.p. **pp** overreact your emotion while playing, very cheesy and fake

Ant. silencio súbito n.p. → scratch With the fingers of your right hand, slowly draw a smile on your face, make it look very fake and forced; it should look as if it is hard to make you smile. Show your teeth and mouth widely open. Pose for a photo. Stay like this.

Ric. silencio súbito n.p. → scratch flautando x.p. slowly prepare a neutral standing position

Elect. 07:06

139

Jul.

Wak.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elect.

Violin and bow in one hand, hold the instrument down, at your side (like when you're not playing). Pose neutrally like in passport photo.

Closed hand, index finger out. Slowly raise your hand to the height of your eyes, with the index finger pointing forwards.

Tap in the air, as liking a photo in your phone.

slowly prepare to play, violin in position

Free your right hand. Stand up neutrally, with the double-bass at your side, like in a passport photo.

Closed hand, index finger out. Slowly raise your hand to the height of your eyes, with the index finger pointing forwards.

Tap in the air, as liking a photo in your phone.



144

Jul.

Wak.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elect.

could be our lovers

could be our fathers

could be our bosses

pp

Exit right behind screen 2

pizz.

p

Exit right behind screen 3

pizz.

Go back to photo pose.

mf

pizz.

arco s.p

pizz.

arco

Neutral pose

Exit right behind screen 1

mf

pp

p

pp

p

07:56



159

Jul. *our bodies in the feed* *so dull, so cheap* *so dull, so cheap* *when we want to be other*

Wak. *Enter right with violin in screen 4*

Zey. *Enter left with cello in screen 3*

Ant. *(arco)* *semi-scratch, one full bow!*

Ric. *semi-scratch, one full bow!*

Elect.

59 104

59 104

ff *ff*

167 $\text{♩} = 75$ **K**

Jul. *in our dreams* $\frac{5}{8}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{4}{4}$ *we prompt*

Wak. $\text{♩} = 75$ semi-scratch, one full bow! **K** n.p. *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf*

Zey. $\frac{12}{8}$

Ant. semi-scratch, one full bow! n.p. *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf* *mf*

Ric.

Elect.

slowly start looking to your right at screen 2.



175

Jul.

Wak. scratch, very granular, slow glissando n.p. *mf* *mf* *f* *mf* *mf*

Zey. $\frac{12}{8}$

Ant. scratch, very granular, slow glissando n.p. *mf* *mf* *f* *mf* *mf*

Ric.

Elec.

181

Jul. *Say it to the front, then
turn your head right
again.
is this justice or cake?*

Wak. *scratch, very granular,
slow glissando*

Zey. *Close curtains in
screen 2* *close* *Behind screen 2*

Ant. *scratch, very granular,
slow glissando*

Ric.

Elec.



188

Jul. *is this true beauty or
freedom or cake?*

Wak. *n.p.* *scratch, very granular,
slow glissando*

Zey.

Ant. *n.p.* *scratch, very granular,
slow glissando*

Ric. *Close curtains in
screen 2* *close* *Behind screen 1*

Elec.

[illegible]

202

Jul.

Wak.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elec.

is this a pipe or a cake?

n.p.

mf

f

scratch, very granular, slow glissando

209

Jul. 

Wak. 

Zey. 

Ant. 

Ric. 

Elec. 

M

M

Close curtains in screen 2

close

Behind screen 2

is this a good son or a cake?

n.p.

mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf>

n.p.

mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf>



216

Jul. 

Wak. 

Zey. 

Ant. 

Ric. 

Elec. 

Enter right with FAKE viola to screen 2. Costume 3.

Simulate you play this

Slowly fall to the ground while playing (as much as you physically can), as if you were being crushed by a hydraulic press. You stay there!

f

scratch, very granular, slow glissando

n.p.

mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf>

n.p.

mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf> mf>

240

Jul.

Wak.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elec.



248

Jul.

Wak.

Zey.

Ant.

Ric.

Elec.

O

O

Exit left behind screen 1